Annette and Gina from Parallel Lives

By Mo Gaffney and Kathy Najimy

Annette and Gina are watching the movie West Side Story on TV and crying.
**Strong Italian accents (Tutorial Video Link at the end of this selection)*

ANNETTE: **(Pgs 29-36)** Oh God.

GINA: What'd you make me watch *West Side Story* for Annette? It was so sad.

ANNETTE: It is my favorite movie of all time!!

GINA: It was so beautiful.

ANNETTE: I think Natalie Wood sings so good in that movie. And she's got the prettiest hair. I hate my hair, Gina.

GINA: Your hair is fine. You know what I just thought of?

ANNETTE: What did you just thought of?

GINA: That movie is a lot like *Romeo and Juliet!* No, just think about it! Juliet's family could not stand Romeo and same with Maria, her family hated Tony.

ANNETTE: I can't believe you thought of that. You are so right, Gina. You know who that's exactly like?

GINA: Who? **ANNETTE:** Who that we know? **GINA:** Who?

ANNETTE: Me! My mother cannot stand Junior. Why? Because he is not Italian. I mean, he could be the Pope or whatever and she would not care.

GINA: That's so unfair.

ANNETTE: What the movie is trying to tell us Gina is everyone is the same on the inside. It's just like Beanie's poem, "Colors." Colors, blue, pink, purple, yellow - it does not matter.

GINA: Does not matter.

ANNETTE: Does not matter.

BOTH: Period.

GINA: That is so beautiful.

ANNETTE: I've got goose bumps.

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INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS 1: *Between the raging hormones, eye rolls and unpredictable behavior,*
ACTRESS 2: *Our perilous journey into adulthood is likely to leave us and our parents exhausted!*
ACTRESS 1: *And in some cases, wondering . . . what the heck just happened?*
ACTRESS 2: *We're here today to give you just a tiny glimpse into the world of teen-age girls --*
ACTRESS 1: *Italian-American style!*
ACTRESS 2: *Live from New Jersey . . . Its*
TOGETHER: *Annette and Gina from Parallel Lives*
ACTRESS 1: *by Mo Gaffney and Kathy Najimy*

GINA: It's like "you can't judge a book by its cover . . . you gotta read it first."

ANNETTE: You can't judge a book by its cover? I mean how would you know what the book is?

GINA: What?

ANNETTE: For instance, say I was gonna buy you a book for your sweet sixteen . . .

GINA: Don't buy me a book. I want a necklace.

ANNETTE: No, just listen. I go into the store and I say I want to buy a book for my play sister Gina but do I say rip off the cover don't show me the cover I don't want to judge? I don't know what the book is. And then I go home, wrap it and give it to you and you say, *why* you give me a book with no cover.

GINA: I don't want a book, Annette

ANNETTE: That's not the point, Gina.

GINA: Just like Maria in that movie. When she fell in love with Tony she had no idea he was a white guy.

ANNETTE: He could dance good so how could she tell.

GINA: I know. There's one thing I didn't get, Annette. You know when she did it with him?

ANNETTE: That's my favorite part.

GINA: Did she know Tony had just stabbed and killed her brother?

ANNETTE: Yes, Gina. Remember? He comes in the bedroom window and he says "I am so sorry I killed your brother," and she still does it with him, like twice.

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GINA: That is so beautiful. And they didn't let it affect their relationship.

ANNETTE: Speaking of true love, I forgot to tell you. I talked to Junior in 6th period jewelry and him and Eddie aren't coming over until way later.

GINA: He is so mean to you, Annette.

ANNETTE: Bah, bah, bah, nah, nah, nah.

GINA: Besides the fact he thinks he is God's gift to the borough which he is not.

ANNETTE: Anyway you want to spend the night tonight?

GINA: Okay. You gonna ask your mother?

ANNETTE: Ma! Could Gina spend the night tonight? I know it is a school night. God.

GINA: What does she think you are a moron or something?

ANNETTE: I guess so. What? You want to eat dinner here?

GINA: What are you having?

ANNETTE: Shells and sauce.

GINA: Okay.

ANNETTE: Okay. Thanks, ma! All right! She says yes!

GINA: All right!

ANNETTE: I hope she doesn't make Junior and Eddie leave early like last time.

GINA: Yeah, well you better not sneak out again like last time and leave me here alone. I thought I was supposed to be your best friend.

ANNETTE: Gina, of course you are my best friend. I would do anything for you. Just like Anita and Maria. But I would never do to you what Anita did to Maria, ever.

GINA: What'd she do?

ANNETTE: Don't you remember, Gina? The part where Maria asked Anita to go give a really important message to Tony to meet her. And Anita was *mad*, I forget why, and said, “Just tell Tony Maria is dead." She wasn't dead, she was like down the street doing laundry or something.

GINA: Annette, number one, they called her tramp, number two they killed her boyfriend, that's why she was *mad*.

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ANNETTE: I hear what you are telling me but she was Maria's best friend! I mean, what if it was you and me?

GINA: Like we're Maria and Anita? I want to be Anita.

ANNETTE: Okay, okay. Now I come to you as my best friend and I ask you to give a really important message to Junior from me. Like . . . he has to meet me at Tower Records across from the Burger King. But first he has to do something to *make you mad*.

GINA: That should be easy.

ANNETTE: No Gina, play right.

GINA: Okay, like what?

ANNETTE: Like anything. Like, say, he goes into your house, your mother's cookin' dinner . . .

GINA: What's she cookin'?

ANNETTE: Shells and sauce, doesn't matter, it's a Wednesday. And he says your mother's cooking smells. Would you still tell him for me?

GINA: Yeah. My mother's cookin' does smell. You can't fault Junior.

ANNETTE: Okay, well what if he did something worse. He goes into your house and cuts your little sister's legs off. Would you still tell him?

GINA: Well, I would be *mad* he cut my sister's legs off but I would still tell him for you. I mean, nobody has been killed here. You understand what I'm saying to you?

ANNETTE: Gina, just pretend. Okay, say he goes into your house and like *kills* your entire family, blood everywhere. But I beg you, I say Gina, as my best friend, and I'm crying and I have a shawl on my head or something. Please Gina, the cops are after us, I am so sorry, don't go to your house it's a mess. Please tell Junior to meet me at the Burger King, ***por favor*** and everything. *(After thought)* What does ***por favor*** mean again?

GINA: It's like "my friend."

ANNETTE: Please Gina you are my best ***por favor***, please tell Junior to meet me at the

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Burger King. Would you do it?

GINA: Okay . . . granted my entire family is dead and my sister is running around with no legs . . . but my boyfriend is still alive and that was the whole point of that movie, so it's totally different here.

ANNETTE: I would do it for you no matter what.

GINA: You would not. Besides, why do you want to go around with a guy who cuts off little girls' legs and kills whole families for?

ANNETTE: That is not the point, Gina! You love them no matter what they do, it's part of being a womanhood. It's like, sure, Maria would not want Tony to kill her brother and I would not want Junior to cut your little sister's legs off or be mean or *mess* around with other girls, but I know he does.

GINA: I know.

ANNETTE: I know he does - you know he does too?

GINA: What?

ANNETTE: Did Eddie tell you something?

GINA: What?

ANNETTE: About Tina Antonelli.

GINA: What? I just know they were at that party together, I don't know they did it.

ANNETTE: All right, I just have this feeling that they did.

GINA: You do?

ANNETTE: And you know Gina, if I found out for sure he did . . .

GINA: As your best friend, what would you do?

ANNETTE: I would not break up with him because I love him.

GINA: I would. But first I would kill him. Then I would kill Tina Antonelli. Then I would break up with him.

ANNETTE: Gina, I am trying to tell you what is in my heart here, okay? You know, Gina, I mean, I just wish I could make Junior love me as much as I love him, you know? And I know, Gina, that if I had better skin or prettier hair he would love me back.

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GINA: It doesn't matter what you look like. You are losing yourself in him, Annette.

ANNETTE: You are right, Gina. I am losing myself. I can't believe you thought of that. You know, sometimes it's like I look in the mirror and think, "Where is Annette? Where is she?" But I just can't get myself back.

GINA: You should just break up with him once and for all.

ANNETTE: Love hurts. On every level, love hurts. I can't believe I thought of that.

GINA: That is so true.

ANNETTE: Love hurts.

GINA: And love is blind.

ANNETTE: Love is a many splendored thing.

GINA: Love is a rose, but you'd better not pick it.

ANNETTE: Love is thicker than water.

GINA: That is so true.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Mo Gaffney and Kathy Najimy
Book: Parallel Lives
ISBN: 978-0822213086
Publisher: Dramatists Play Service
Date (Month/Year): Jan 1998

AWARD HISTORY

2022 National Qualifier – MS
IL State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

**** Italian dialect Video Link***
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qlu6lDuml_I

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